The End of the Slave Trade

During the American Civil War, the Unionists and the Confederates were fighting for many reasons, one of which was the right to abolish slavery. President Lincoln was somewhat hesitant in abolishing slavery initially but eventually changed his view. The Emancipation Proclamation was declared on the 23rdof September 1862, which granted freedom to slaves in the rebel states at the start of 1863. This was quickly amended with the 13th amendment and freedom was granted to all slaves.

The Union won the civil war and it led to legislative repealing of slavery but that did not mean that the struggle for black people was over. The 13th amendment abolished slavery and the constitution was officially amended. African Americans were now legally equal to Caucasians but the new laws were ignored and violated in many cases by the public.

The fight against racial discrimination continued for the next 100 years as African Americans faced inequality in various forms. Former slaves had difficulty finding work and many were forced to live in poverty. The new laws led to the rise of hate groups such as the Ku Klux Klan, which propagated hate speech and brutally murdered many black people.

Furthermore, the Jim Crow laws were enacted by the governments at the state and local levels. According to these laws, black people were considered equal to white people but were required to remain separate from them. The public infrastructure was divided so that black people were not allowed to share the same space as white people.

Finally, the Civil Rights Movement in the 1900s successfully launched various protests and boycotts to end white hegemony. The struggle was difficult and time-consuming in which many people died. Notable people during this time include Martin Luther King Jr., Malcolm X, Rosa Parks and Thurgood Marshall. At the end of this movement, the Jim Crow laws were repealed.